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Principles for My Son

A Note From Your [Father](/lexicon/father) My son, I am writing these principles so that, whatever life throws at us, you will never be in doubt about what I...

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A Note From Your Father

My son,

I am writing these principles so that, whatever life throws at us, you will never be in doubt about **what I believe, what I pray for you, and how I expect you to walk as a man.**

These are not slogans. They are **anchors** for when life feels confusing, unfair or overwhelming.

2. Guard Your Integrity at All Costs

There are things you can lose and recover: money, deals, opportunities. There are things you cannot easily recover: **trust, honour, credibility.**

- Say what you mean.
- Do what you said you would do.
- If you fail, own it quickly and repair it fully.

I would rather see you **honest and struggling** than successful and crooked.

4. Work Hard, Work Smart, Rest Well

Laziness will quietly erode your potential. Workaholism will quietly erode your soul.

- Learn to **work hard** - with focus, discipline and excellence.
- Learn to **work smart** - prioritise, think, plan.
- Learn to **rest well** - sleep, take breaks, enjoy beauty and silence.

You are not a machine. You are a man created for **purpose, not just output.**

6. Choose Your Friends Carefully

The people you walk with will shape:

- Your habits
- Your decisions
- Your vision of what is "normal"

Walk with men who:

- Tell you the truth
- Challenge you when you drift
- Celebrate your growth without envy

Do not confuse **attention** with **loyalty.**

8. Learn to Handle Money Wisely

Money is a tool, not a master.

- Live below your means.
- Avoid unnecessary debt.
- Give generously and quietly.
- Save and invest with patience, not greed.

If you master your appetites, you will not be easily mastered by money.

10. Build for Legacy, Not Just for Today

Life is short. Eternity is long. People are watching even when you think they are not.

Ask yourself often:

- *"What am I building that will outlive me?"*
- *"What kind of story will my life tell about God, about manhood, about fatherhood?"*

I want you to live in such a way that **your children and their children** can thank God for the decisions you made.

Final Word

My son,

You will make mistakes. So did I. So will every man you admire. What matters is that you **keep returning to truth, to God, and to who you are called to be.**

Whatever happens:

> *You are my son. I love you. I want you to stand, to build, and to walk without fear.*

Your father.